

Meriç Erler

Game economy & F2P systems · data-driven balancing · Berlin

mericerler@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/mericerler · github.com/merogith · Berlin

— Profile

I design and balance game economies — and I got here the long way round: three years pulling signal out of messy data across pharma, edtech and equity research, plus a stubborn habit of taking games apart to see how their economies hold up. To prove I could do the job I built a full economy-design study on **Idle Bank Tycoon** — two live-ops levers, each modelled end-to-end with ROI math, a sensitivity grid and an A/B plan. I build and ship my own browser games too, so a system reads to me from both the spreadsheet and the code.

— Core skills

Game economy & F2P	Economy modelling & balancing · sources/sinks & inflation · progression curves · monetisation (IAP, rewarded ads, ARPPAU / ARPPU, eCPM) · retention (D1/D7/D30) · player segmentation
Spreadsheet modelling	Parameter-driven models in Google Sheets — 400+ linked formulas, sensitivity grids, scenario / A/B design
Data & methods	Python (pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels) · SQL (window functions) · A/B testing · regression · z-tests · logistic models · forecasting
BI & reporting	Tableau · Power BI · Looker Studio · Google Analytics · KPI dashboards
Build	Custom JS / TS game engines (Canvas, game loop, rules-vs-render separation) — concepts that carry over to Unity · Supabase · Git

— Selected projects

Idle Bank Tycoon — Game Economy Design Case Study

Spreadsheet model · A/B design

- Found the late-game problem in the numbers: by level 60, idle cash piles to **4,900-21,600×** the next upgrade's cost — progression stops mattering. Diagnosed by rebuilding the full income-vs-cost curve (**400+ linked formulas**, one inputs tab).
- Designed two live-ops levers to fix it — a hard-currency liquidity lock and income-scaled rewarded-ad tuning — modelling blended **ARPPAU +15.5%** (~\$2M/yr at static DAU) with a sensitivity grid and retention guardrails. My call: ship the ads first, treat the loan as the bigger retention bet.

Free-to-Play Game Economy & Balance

Python · scikit-learn · SQL

- Caught two premium items quietly breaking the game (**61% win rate**, significant on a z-test) and slow coin inflation — sinks claw back only ~**63%** of what's minted — each paired with the balancing fix.
- Flagged future payers from their first three days (**AUC 0.80**) via D1/D7/D30 cohorts, turning it into an onboarding lever, not a dashboard metric.

US Stock-Market Valuation & Risk

Python · statsmodels (OLS) · SQL

- Showed across **150+ years** that expensive markets pay back less: higher valuation (CAPE) predicts **lower** forward 10-year real returns (**p ≈ 1e-40**); worst real drawdown **-81%**. Built for a decision, not a paper.

Also built & exploring

Custom JS engines · Supabase

- Battle** — Pokémon-style turn-based RPG with **online PvP** on an engine I wrote from scratch (+ Supabase); **RocketIO** — real-time hex strategy with an in-game **missile economy**; plus mobile-first demos. All phone & desktop responsive — merogith.github.io/Portfolio.
- Next on my list — idle games:** *Berlin Döner Haus*, an idle tycoon inspired by the Dönerbox at U8; and a single-player idle RPG in a WoW-style MMO world, drawing on Slayer Legend, Tap Titans, Legends of Idleon and Clicker Heroes.

— Experience

Independent Financial Coach — Self-employed

2024 – Present

- Run a one-to-one practice turning budgeting, saving and investing into plain, actionable decisions; design each client's plan and run weekly check-ins in English and Turkish.

Business Intelligence Analyst — Saksı Kampüs (early-stage edtech)

Dec 2021 – Oct 2022

- Tracked retention, engagement and CAC in Google Analytics & Looker Studio and steered Meta Ads spend; wrote the business plan and growth projections behind a seed crowdfunding raise.

Omnichannel Data Analyst — Viatris Inc.

Dec 2022 – Sep 2023

- Consolidated records into one master record per person across **70+ markets** (Salesforce); fuzzy matching cut manual validation by **40%**. Cleaned 1M+ records with SQL.

Sales & Financial Analysis Intern — Garanti BBVA Investment

Jul 2021 – Sep 2021

- Built DCF and comparable-company valuation models and set target prices for sell-side equity research.

— Education

M.Sc. Corporate Management — University of Europe for Applied Sciences, Berlin

2022 – 2024

B.Sc. Environmental Engineering — METU, Ankara

2013 – 2021

Honors: Published paper, *Generative AI in Pharma* (ADCAIJ) · Google AI Essentials · METU summer-practice award

— Languages

English – full professional · Turkish – native · Dual Portuguese / Turkish citizen (EU work-authorized) · available immediately